

Supraventricular Tachycardias

Sinus Tachycardia

Regular, typically <160bpm

Increased automaticity of the sinus node typically in response to stress.

Junctional Tachycardia

Regular, no 'p' waves, <150bpm

Increased automaticity of the AV node that "escapes" the sinus

AV-RT

Atrial Fibrillation

Irregularly irregular, no 'p' waves

Multiple micro re-entry circuits typically in the left atrium. These circuits are in constant competition to depolarize the atria which leads to the "fibrillating" pattern with varying AV conduction. Managed with rate control by nodal blockade and anti-coagulation to reduce stroke risk. However, some patients

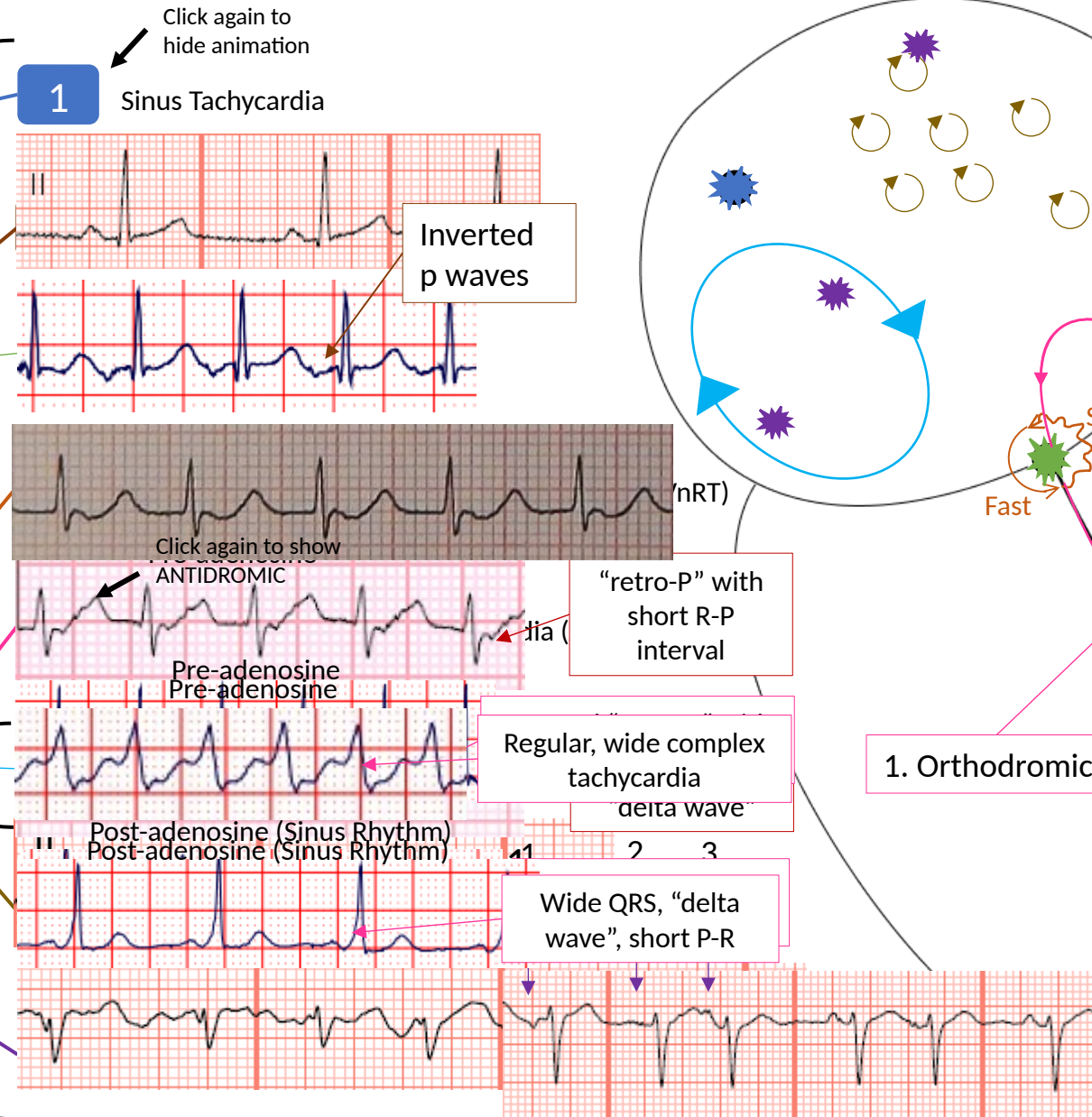
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Irregular, multiple 'p' morphologies

This rhythm is similar to atrial tachycardia but has multiple ectopic pacemakers, instead of just one. This is often mistaken as atrial fibrillation but will often resolve with resolution of the acute condition (e.g. sepsis, COPD exacerbation).

Regular

Irregular



Key

- Increased automaticity
- Re-entry circuit